

Gestures and movement

Gestures can make a presenter seem more enthusiastic and engaging. Speakers often wave their hands around to emphasize certain points and catch an audience's attention. Walking around a room makes a delivery more personal because the speaker moves closer to certain individuals. Making eye contact with individuals in an audience is also important.



- A speaker must sound **enthusiastic**. If he or she sounds bored, the audience will be, too.
- It can be useful to **practice** a speech in front of a **mirror**.



△ Enthusiasm

Enthusiastic gestures, such as punching the air or waving, can make a speaker seem more passionate.



△ Big ideas

Some actions—for example, spreading out the arms—can emphasize the size of an issue.

Maintain eye contact to engage the audience.

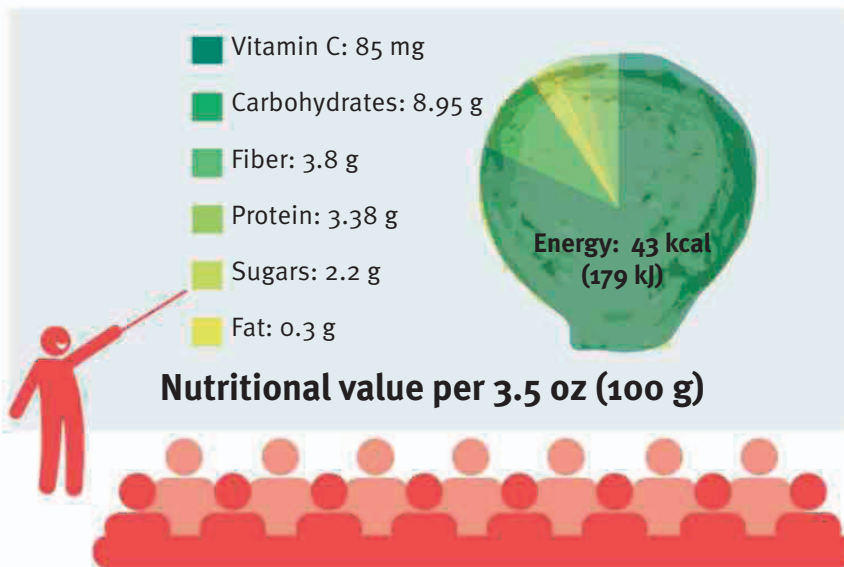


△ Distraction

It's important not to move around too much. Awkward movements can distract an audience from what the speaker is saying.

Visual aids

Sometimes speakers use visual aids to engage their audiences. These include images, graphs, and diagrams that explain complicated information or make it more interesting. Summarizing key points on a projector slide or handout will also emphasize the most important details, and help the audience to remember them.



REAL WORLD

Dressing down

Public speakers even think about the way they dress when speaking to an audience. Some politicians or business professionals decide not to wear a suit and tie when making a speech to the public. By wearing more casual clothes, they hope that they will look more relaxed and approachable, so the audience will relate to them.

